CISMA
Corpus-Informed Studies: Methodologies and Applications

Khazar University

BOOK OF ABSTRACTS

2ND CISMA CONFERENCE ON TECHNOLOGY AND CORPORA IN DISCOURSE, TRANSLATION AND INTERPRETING

30 APRIL 2026
MARBLE HALL - KHAZAR UNIVERSITY, BAKU, AZERBAIJAN



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WELCOME MESSAGE FROM THE CONFERENCE CHAIR



Founder & Co-Chair,
CISMA

Muhammad Afzaal

Dear colleagues, scholars, and research partners,
It is my great honor to welcome you to the CISMA conference platform, an academic space founded to bring together the brightest minds working at the intersection of corpus linguistics, NLP, discourse studies, translation, and interpreting.CISMA is more than a conference; it is a collaborative global network bringing together early-career researchers, senior academics, technologists, and practitioners who use digital tools and corpus-driven methods to advance the language sciences. I look forward to welcoming you and working together to strengthen our collective contribution to global scholarship.

Conference Organizing Team

Institute of Language Sciences, Shanghai International Studies University



Kaibao Hu



Muhammad Afzaal



Shanshan Xiao

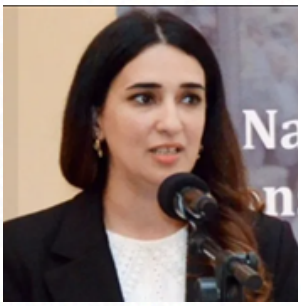


Qiang Geng

Khazar University



Hamlet Isaxanli



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Tamela Mammadli

ABOUT THE PROGRAM

MAIN CONFERENCE TRACKS

CISMA 2026 brings together seven connected areas of corpus-informed language research.

TECHNOLOGY IN DISCOURSE ANALYSIS

APPLICATIONS OF TOPIC MODELING AND AI-DRIVEN TOOLS IN CRITICAL DISCOURSE ANALYSIS.

CORPORA AND LANGUAGE SCIENCES

INNOVATIONS IN CORPUS LINGUISTICS FOR ADVANCING LANGUAGE STUDIES AND PEDAGOGY.

CORPORA IN TRANSLATION STUDIES

ENHANCING TRANSLATION PRACTICES THROUGH DATA-DRIVEN INSIGHTS.

INTERDISCIPLINARY APPROACHES

BRIDGING HUMANITIES, SOCIAL SCIENCES, AND COMPUTATIONAL RESEARCH THROUGH CORPUS METHODS.

NLP AND SENTIMENT ANALYSIS

NLP METHODS FOR ANALYZING SENTIMENT AND EMOTIONS IN LANGUAGE DATA.

OPINION MINING IN SOCIAL, POLITICAL, AND CULTURAL DISCOURSE

RESEARCH ON OPINION AND EVALUATION ACROSS PUBLIC, POLITICAL, AND CULTURAL COMMUNICATION.

PLENARY SESSION

30 APRIL 2026 | MARBLE HALL, KHAZAR UNIVERSITY, BAKU | ONSITE

Visualizing Knowledge, Framing Evidence: A Diachronic Study of Graphical Markers in Social Science Research Writing



Muhammad Afzaal

SHANGHAI INTERNATIONAL STUDIES UNIVERSITY

ABSTRACT

As social science research becomes increasingly data-driven, tables, figures, and statistical visualizations play a more prominent role in scholarly communication. Yet the linguistic devices used to introduce and interpret these visual elements, known as graphical markers, remain underexplored. This keynote presents findings from a diachronic corpus-based study of research articles in Applied Linguistics, Education, and Management across 2005, 2015, and 2025. Drawing on a multidimensional analytical framework, the study traces changing patterns in how writers reference and integrate visual evidence. The results reveal a general increase in graphical markers from 2005 to 2015 across all disciplines, followed by continued growth in Applied Linguistics and Education but a decline in Management. Significant disciplinary differences are found in the use of non-integral and contextual markers, reflecting contrasting rhetorical approaches to presenting evidence. The keynote argues that graphical markers offer an important lens for understanding evolving disciplinary practices, academic argumentation, and the relationship between language and visualized knowledge.

ABOUT THE SPEAKER

Muhammad Afzaal is an Associate Professor at the Institute of Corpus Studies and Applications, Shanghai International Studies University. He earned his PhD from Shanghai Jiao Tong University and has held a research fellowship at The Hong Kong Polytechnic University. His work spans corpus linguistics, discourse studies, and language technology. He has authored books on Belt and Road discourse and technology in applied linguistics, and developed LexiConc, a tool for concordance and lexical-bundle analysis.

PLENARY SESSION

30 APRIL 2026 | MARBLE HALL, KHAZAR UNIVERSITY, BAKU | ONSITE

Development of Translation Studies in the Context of Large Language Models: Issues and Prospects



Kaibao Hu

SHANGHAI INTERNATIONAL STUDIES UNIVERSITY

ABSTRACT

The use of large language models has brought tremendous opportunities and challenges to translation practice and research. Following an introductory account of the development as well as the main features of large language models, this article analyzes the impacts their use has made on translation research and goes on to speculate on the future of translation studies as a result of this new development. It concludes that the use of large language models in translation practice has brought many changes to the subjects of translation and the attributes of translated texts, forcing translation scholars to rethink a wide range of issues concerning translation ethics, translator subjectivity, translator styles and ideology in translation, and it has also brought about changes in methodology of translation research, ushering in a growing trend toward data-driven and visualization-based approaches.

ABOUT THE SPEAKER

Kaibao Hu has more than twenty years of research experience in corpus-based translation studies. He has published extensively in major Chinese and international journals and is the author of nine academic monographs, including work issued by Springer and China's Higher Education Press. He has led numerous national-level research projects and has been recognized among China's influential scholars in philosophy and the social sciences.

PLENARY SESSION

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The Architecture of Equilibrium: Complexity Trade-offs and the Equi-complexity Hypothesis



Lei Lei

SHANGHAI INTERNATIONAL STUDIES UNIVERSITY

ABSTRACT

The complexity trade-off hypothesis suggests that difficulty in one linguistic domain, such as word-level morphology, is often counterbalanced by simplicity in another, such as sentence-level syntax. The concept is rooted in the equi-complexity hypothesis, which posits that all human languages maintain a comparable level of total complexity despite their diversity. The principle is significant for understanding how languages are shaped by cognitive constraints and the demands of efficient communication. In this keynote, I will review the current state of research in this field and present our team's recent findings, which offer new insights into how these trade-offs manifest across diverse language families.

ABOUT THE SPEAKER

Lei Lei is Professor of Applied Linguistics at Shanghai International Studies University. His research uses corpus and NLP methods to study lexical and syntactic patterns in Modern Chinese, Classical Chinese, and English. He also works on second-language writing and digital humanities. He has authored five books and more than fifty international journal articles, led two projects funded by the China National Social Science Fund, and serves in editorial roles for journals in academic writing and corpus-based humanities.

PLENARY SESSION

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Translating Islam and Palestine: Digital Diplomacy and the Struggle over Global Meaning



Abdel-Wahab Khalifa

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ABSTRACT

Every war is fought twice: once on the ground and once over how its story is told and understood. This second battle is more pervasive, waged through narrative rather than arms, with translation serving as one of its most powerful instruments. This keynote argues that in the digital age, translation functions as a concealed infrastructure of power. Visible as a technical practice yet often inconspicuous in its hegemonic effects, it helps shape what becomes legible, credible and true, pre-structuring interpretation itself.

Through the lens of Islam and Palestine, two of the most relentlessly translated and systematically distorted sites of global meaning-making through which Muslims and Palestinians are made legible in global public culture, I explore how state and non-state actors deploy translation across digital platforms, messaging and algorithmic ecosystems to engineer interpretation. What is at stake is not merely representation but the production of interpretive conditions. Translation operates as a political mechanism that organises how events are perceived, who counts as grievable and which histories enter public recognition. It becomes the process through which legitimacy and threat are unevenly distributed, authorising some subjects as modern, democratic and civilised while casting others as suspect, excessive or backward.

The keynote concludes by tracing how this work of projection changes when it becomes increasingly automated. When geopolitical meaning-making is outsourced to artificial intelligence, historical bias is not erased; it is encoded and naturalised. It becomes scalable, recursive and harder to detect. To examine translation today is to confront one of the central questions of our time: who determines the interpretive conditions under which the world can be understood?

ABOUT THE SPEAKER

Abdel-Wahab Khalifa is Senior Lecturer in Translation and Interpreting at Queen's University Belfast. His research examines translation in relation to soft power, propaganda, diplomacy, and Arabo-Islamic social history. He has published in leading journals and contributed to major reference works on Arabic translation. He serves on international advisory and executive boards, is Editor-in-Chief of The Translator, and co-edits Encounters in Translation.

PLENARY SESSION

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Metapragmatics of 'Influencing' and Influencer Flip on the Microblogging Platform BlueSky



Daria Dayter

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ABSTRACT

This study investigates the evolving discourses surrounding the term "influencer" within the context of migration from Twitter to BlueSky, using Davies and Harre's (1990) positioning analysis and the methodological toolkit of corpus-assisted discourse analysis. I will first introduce the discourse keyword "influencer" and survey its contexts of use on early social media. I will then introduce the relatively new addition to the frontrunners of social media landscape, the microblogging platform BlueSky, which will serve as the data source for the present study.

Using a 1,5 mio words corpus of BlueSky posts, I examine how this term is used and perceived during three waves of user migration from Twitter/X, characterised by their respective sociocultural and platform-specific dynamics (October 2022, Musk's purchase of Twitter; February 2024, invite no longer needed; November 2024, the US election). I analyse three complementary analytical frames: the collocational profiles of modifier constructions ([adjective/noun] + influencer), keyword distributions across waves, and storyline content of the influencer + be grammatical frame.

I interpret the findings through Positioning Theory, arguing that the data provide corpus-linguistic evidence for the influencer flip: the discursive reversal of the category influencer from a broadly aspirational, commercial identity to a politically coded and institutionally threatening one within this community.

ABOUT THE SPEAKER

Daria Dayter is Associate Professor of English Linguistics at Tampere University, Finland. She holds a PhD from the University of Bayreuth and a habilitation from the University of Basel. Her research covers global and digital English, corpus linguistics, and discourse analysis. She is Editor-in-Chief of Pragmatics & Society, Director of Tampere University's PLURAL research centre, and has held editorial roles with Target, Discourse Studies, and Internet Pragmatics.

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Reconsidering Originality in AI-assisted L2 Engineering Reports: A Multidimensional NLP-based Analysis



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ABSTRACT

The examination of AI-generated plagiarism has become a critical concern in second language (L2) writing, particularly in safeguarding academic integrity and originality amid the widespread accessibility of large language models (LLMs) among L2 learners. In response to this growing challenge, many higher education institutions (HEIs) have introduced new policies regulating the use of AI in student coursework. The present study addresses this concern by employing Biber's (1988) multidimensional (MD) framework to systematically examine the functional and situational characteristics of students' writing tasks. In doing so, we compiled a large corpus, EngiReport consisting of 250 final-year engineering reports submitted by Chinese L2 students from four departments at a university in Hong Kong S.A.R. The results showed that Dimension3 emerges as the strongest predicator for GenAI rates in the regression analysis, also ranking first in the classification model with the co-efficient 0.7623. In addition, dimensional inclusion analysis further reveals that classification model achieves its hight performance with the combination of Dimension3, Dimension6, Dimension1, Dimension2, yielding a Cohen's Kappa of 0.0666 and an accuracy of 0.3867. A parallel analysis of lexico-grammatical features indicated that model performance peaked with the inclusion of 44 features, led by the type–token ratio (TTR). These findings provide important implications for L2 writing instruction and institutional policies in higher education, offering novel insights into AI–student collaboration in engineering contexts.

Keywords: NLP; L2 writing; Assessment; Multidimensional analysis; AI plagiarism; AI-assisted writing

ABOUT THE SPEAKER

Barbara Wing-Yee Siu is Senior Lecturer in Civil and Environmental Engineering at The Hong Kong Polytechnic University. She earned her PhD in Civil and Environmental Engineering from the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology. With more than fifteen years of teaching experience, she has developed transportation-engineering courses and pursued research on blended learning, internationalization, and communication enhancement. She is a Chartered Engineer, a Senior Fellow of the Higher Education Academy, and a recipient of multiple teaching-innovation awards.

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01

TRACK 01

Technology in Discourse Analysis

Selected abstracts and emerging research

Cross-Lingual Alzheimer's Detection Using Supervised Embeddings with Few-Shot Transfer Learning

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ABSTRACT

Speech-based Alzheimer's disease (AD) detection offers a non-invasive route to cognitive screening, but most available resources remain concentrated in English, limiting deployment in low-resource languages. We address cross-lingual AD detection on the ADReSS-M benchmark, where models trained mainly on English spontaneous speech must generalize to Greek with limited target-language supervision. We propose a transcript-free two-stage framework in which a pretrained Wav2 Vec2 encoder is fine-tuned on English speech with a lightweight prosodic branch, and the resulting attention-pooled acoustic embeddings are adapted to Greek through an attention-based classifier with mixed-batch few-shot transfer. Across five random seeds, the proposed framework achieved Greek test accuracies ranging from 73.68% to 84.21%, with the best model reaching 84.21% accuracy and 83.33% F1-score. These results suggest that supervised acoustic embedding transfer is a promising direction for cross-lingual transcript-free AD detection.

The Role of Artificial Intelligence in Discourse Analysis

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ABSTRACT

In recent years, Artificial Intelligence (AI) has begun to play a significant role in linguistic research, particularly in discourse analysis. This study explores how AI-based tools can support researchers in analyzing spoken and written discourse in educational settings. As traditional discourse analysis often requires extensive manual coding and interpretation, AI technologies offer new possibilities for identifying patterns, key lexical items, interactional moves, and discourse structures more efficiently.

This research focuses on the application of AI tools in examining classroom and online academic discourse. The study considers how AI can assist in detecting feedback strategies, teacher-student interaction patterns, and communicative features in educational contexts. At the same time, it critically discusses the limitations of AI, emphasizing that human interpretation remains essential for ensuring depth, accuracy, and contextual understanding.

The findings suggest that AI can enhance the analytical process by improving efficiency and organization, while serving as a supportive instrument rather than a replacement for the researcher. The study highlights the importance of combining technological tools with critical human analysis in contemporary discourse research.

Mapping Feminist Resistance in South Asian English Poetry: A Pragma-Stylistic and NVivo-Assisted Thematic Analysis

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ABSTRACT

Feminist literary research has transformed to digital qualitative methods to strengthen interpretive rigor without sacrificing textual sensitivity. Our study focused on comparative corpus-assisted thematic analysis of two landmark feminist poetry collections from South Asia-Kishwar Naheed's Compositions of a Scorched Heart and Meena Kandasamy's Ms. Militancy. We employed NVivo as a computer-assisted qualitative data analysis software (CAQDAS) to systematically code feminist themes across the two corpora, focusing on gender identity, patriarchy, empowerment, resistance, and sisterhood.

We conducted qualitative thematic coding, sentiment distribution, and cross-corpus comparison on selected works grounded in feminist theory and qualitative rigor. Our results suggest both convergence and divergence in feminist articulation. Naheed's work demonstrated relational feminist ethos rooted in collective solidarity, whereas Kandasamy's poetry articulates a confrontational feminist politics shaped by caste and militant resistance. We demonstrated how stylistic structures serve as both aesthetic and political instruments to analyse feminist discourse using the CAQDAS method in literary research.

KEYWORDS *Feminist poetry, pragma-stylistics, NVivo, thematic analysis, South Asian literature.*

AI Adoption in Teaching: A Technology Acceptance Model Perspective and Psychological Impacts

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ABSTRACT

This study examines the adoption of artificial intelligence (AI) in teaching through the lens of the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM), focusing on how perceived usefulness and perceived ease of use shape educators' intentions to integrate AI-driven tools into instructional practices. As AI becomes increasingly embedded in pedagogy, its psychological impacts, ranging from increased confidence and reduced workload to anxiety, uncertainty, and concerns over professional identity, have become critical considerations.

The study highlights how trust in AI systems, perceived control, and cognitive load influence acceptance decisions. The findings suggest that while AI-supported teaching can enhance efficiency and engagement, successful adoption requires addressing psychological barriers, providing adequate training, and ensuring transparency in AI operations.

KEYWORDS *Corpus, Technology, Language, Artificial Intelligence, Teaching, TAM, Psychology.*

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02

TRACK 02

Corpora and Language Sciences

Selected abstracts and emerging research

Formation of Azerbaijani Language Corpus Resources: Structure, Methodology, and Application Opportunities

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ABSTRACT

The present study explores the formation of corpus resources for the Azerbaijani language, focusing on structural design, database modeling, and concordance development. In the context of ongoing digital transformation, the systematic collection, processing, and annotation of linguistic data have become central to corpus linguistics. The purpose of this research is to develop an initial corpus model of the Azerbaijani language and to demonstrate its functionality through concordance generation.The materials of the study consist of literary texts by prominent Azerbaijani authors, including Hüseyn Javid, Mikayil Mushfig, and Sabir Rustamkhanli, and the research is conducted on concordances compiled based on the complete works of these authors. Based on these texts, a multi-level corpus architecture was constructed using a relational database system. The corpus is organized hierarchically across several layers: authors, works, and textual units (pages and sentence-level segments). Each unit is enriched with metadata such as author name, title of the work, page number, and word count, enabling systematic indexing and retrieval.

Methodologically, the study employs descriptive analysis, structural-semantic approaches, corpus annotation techniques, and SQL-based database modeling. The concordances were implemented using Microsoft SQL Server as the database management system, with Microsoft SQL Server Management Studio (SSMS) employed for data structuring, querying, and concordance generation. Particular attention is given to the development of concordances derived from the corpus data. The concordance system allows for the extraction of all contextual occurrences of a given lexical item, providing a powerful tool for analyzing lexical, semantic, and discourse-level patterns.The results indicate that the constructed corpus and its concordance outputs serve as an effective resource for linguistic research. They enable frequency analysis, lexical studies, discourse analysis, and applications in natural language processing (NLP). Moreover, the structured nature of the database facilitates scalability and integration with artificial intelligence systems. In conclusion, the proposed corpus model and concordance system contribute significantly to the digital representation of the Azerbaijani language and provide a solid foundation for future developments in corpus linguistics and language technologies.

KEYWORDS *corpus linguistics, concordance, Azerbaijani language, database modeling, text processing, NLP.*

Corpus-Driven ESP Pedagogy: Fostering Terminological Competence through Specialized Corpora

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ABSTRACT

The integration of corpus linguistics into language pedagogy has transformed how learners engage with authentic language data, yet specialized corpus applications in English for Specific Purposes (ESP) remain underexplored, particularly with non-linguist students. This study investigates the potential of implementing freely available specialized corpora in ESP classrooms to enhance terminological competence and foster learner autonomy.

The study employed a mixed-methods approach with 39 undergraduate environmental science students (B2-C1 CEFR proficiency) at Peoples' Friendship University of Russia. Over a 16-week semester, participants received systematic training on Eco Lexicon-a 23-million-word specialized corpus of environmental texts accessible via the Sketch Engine platform. The pedagogical intervention progressed through three phases: orientation and guided practice (weeks 1-4), independent corpus-based assignments with classroom follow-up (weeks 5-14), and final evaluation (weeks 15-16). Students explored corpus functions including normalized frequencies for authentic lexical choices, wildcard searches for multi-word expressions, and the word sketch difference tool for near-synonym disambiguation. Data collection comprised de-identified questionnaires assessing perceived complexity, open-ended feedback on challenges and benefits, and analysis of students' revised written productions.

This study makes three significant contributions to corpus linguistics and language pedagogy. First, it demonstrates that specialized corpora can serve as accessible reference tools for non-linguist students when pedagogically scaffolded, challenging assumptions that corpus applications require extensive linguistic training. Second, it provides empirical evidence that corpus consultation addresses terminological asymmetries between source and target languages, a critical need in rapidly evolving technical domains where lexical gaps require informed term creation. Third, the findings reveal that guided corpus exploration cultivates critical awareness of automated translation limitations, fostering analytical skills transferable beyond the classroom. For practitioners, this research offers working strategies for integrating specialized corpora into ESP curricula, while for corpus linguists, it underscores the importance of user-centered design in expanding corpus applications beyond traditional linguistic research contexts.

Research Article Titles as a Disciplinary Micro-Genre: A Corpus-Based Comparison across Hard and Soft Sciences

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ABSTRACT

Research article (RA) titles constitute a highly conventionalized micro-genre that performs essential communicative functions in academic discourse. Despite their brevity, titles encode important disciplinary norms, including preferred rhetorical structures, levels of information density, and strategies of reader engagement. Because they are both compact and highly visible, RA titles provide valuable material for investigating how disciplinary communities package and communicate knowledge.

This paper examines structural and rhetorical patterns in research article titles across four disciplines representing both soft and hard sciences: Linguistics, Political Science, Genetics, and Condensed Matter Physics. The study is based on a corpus of more than 12,000 titles extracted from leading international journals in each field. The analysis combines quantitative corpus methods with qualitative genre analysis to identify disciplinary conventions in title length, structural complexity, and rhetorical framing.

The findings reveal clear cross-disciplinary differences. Titles in the soft sciences (Linguistics and Political Science) tend to exhibit greater syntactic complexity and variation, frequently incorporating multi-part constructions, interrogatives, and occasionally metaphorical or allusive elements. In contrast, titles in the hard sciences (Genetics and Condensed Matter Physics) are typically more informationally dense, favoring compact nominal structures. These differences reflect broader epistemic orientations: interpretive disciplines appear to allow greater rhetorical flexibility, whereas experimental sciences prioritize precision and terminological specificity.

Beyond documenting these structural differences, the paper argues that RA titles represent a valuable dataset for genre-based pedagogy. Their brevity and accessibility facilitate pedagogical use in academic writing instruction, particularly in interdisciplinary classrooms. The findings therefore contribute both to research on disciplinary discourse and to the development of corpus-informed approaches to teaching academic writing.

KEYWORDS *research article titles, cross-disciplinary variation, academic discourse.*

Translating Culture-Specific Expressions: Developing a Learner Corpus for Translation Training

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ABSTRACT

Translating from one's native language to the target language is obviously a challenging task because it requires a sophisticated level of intercultural awareness and competence beyond simply finding word equivalents. No matter how machine learning and artificial intelligence have improved translation studies in today's digital era, human translations still serve as the basis for everyday spoken and written communications. In this respect, the development of learners' translation skills remains an important issue, particularly in English language teaching (ELT) departments.

Conducted in an ELT setting, this study aims to explore ELT students' translation practices regarding culture-specific expressions. Given that culture-specific translations require due attention because idioms or culturally bound phrases are rooted in social, context-specific, and real-life experiences, it is profoundly significant to shed light on learners' translations of cultural expressions by scrutinizing common errors, recurring patterns, and difficulty levels. Accordingly, in this study, a sample of ELT students was asked to translate a text including cultural elements. Then, culture-specific translations were compiled into a small-scale learner corpus and analyzed both quantitatively and qualitatively. The analysis findings were used as sources to develop a learner corpus, especially for translation training.

To sum up, the current study highlights the importance of intercultural awareness in translation studies and spotlights the development of a learner corpus for culture-specific translations.

KEYWORDS *translation, culture-specific expressions, translation training.*

Operationalizing OCR Noise in Historical Corpora: A Taxonomy-Based Error Model and Pilot Corpus Diagnostics

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ABSTRACT

Purpose: This work-in-progress paper proposes an operational taxonomy of OCR noise for historical print corpora and argues that error modeling itself should be treated as a core methodological step in corpus preparation. Rather than approaching OCR correction primarily as a general cleaning workflow, the study focuses on describing recurrent error types in a way that supports transparent, corpus-sensitive preprocessing and more reliable linguistic analysis.

Methodology: The paper develops a taxonomy of OCR noise for late nineteenth-and early twentieth-century English print materials, organized into functionally distinct classes (e.g., character confusions, line-break and hyphenation artifacts, layout intrusions, segmentation inconsistencies, and non-lexical token pollution). For each class, the study defines observable criteria, typical textual signatures, and class-specific correction heuristics. A pilot dataset is manually examined to refine category boundaries and identify ambiguous cases. The taxonomy is then applied to a small corpus sample to generate error-class profiles and targeted preprocessing decisions, followed by corpus-oriented diagnostics comparing untreated and class-targeted outputs.

Summary of findings/results (preliminary): Preliminary results suggest that OCR noise is patterned rather than random and that a limited number of recurring classes account for most high-impact distortions across the sample. Class-targeted preprocessing appears to offer a more methodologically stable alternative than undifferentiated cleaning, reducing persistent non-lexical artifacts and improving the interpretability of frequency-based and phraseological outputs.

Conclusion: A taxonomy-based error model offers a principled alternative to ad hoc OCR correction by making preprocessing decisions explicit, revisable, and corpus-sensitive.

Significance/Contributions: The paper contributes a transferable OCR noise taxonomy, a set of operational diagnostics for error-class profiling, and a methodological framework for documenting preprocessing decisions in historical corpus research across language sciences and corpus-based humanities.

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03

TRACK 04

Corpora in Translation Studies

Selected abstracts and emerging research

Terminological Alignment in United Nations Documents: Insights from Parallel Corpus Methodology

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ABSTRACT

Terminological consistency in multilingual institutional discourse remains a critical challenge, particularly in the context of United Nations (UN) documentation, where semantic precision directly affects legal interpretation, policy implementation, and cross-cultural communication. This study explores the principles and practices of terminological alignment in UN documents through the lens of parallel corpus methodology, with special attention to Uzbek-language translations. The research is grounded in a specially compiled parallel corpus consisting of aligned UN texts in English and Uzbek, enabling systematic comparison of lexical, semantic, and pragmatic features across languages.

The study proposes a multi-level framework for terminological alignment that integrates linguistic, cognitive, and corpus-driven approaches. At the macro level, alignment is achieved through the identification of domain-specific conceptual structures and their standardized representation across languages. At the micro level, the methodology involves sentence-level and term-level alignment using concordance tools, frequency analysis, and context-sensitive mapping of equivalents. Special emphasis is placed on resolving issues of non-equivalence, polysemy, and culturally bound terms through strategies such as borrowing, calquing, descriptive translation, and functional adaptation.

In the case of Uzbek translations of UN documents, the research identifies several recurring challenges, including inconsistencies in rendering key institutional terms, variation in syntactic structures, and the influence of intermediary languages such as Russian. The study demonstrates that a corpus-based approach allows for the detection of these inconsistencies and supports the development of standardized terminological databases and translation guidelines. Furthermore, the integration of corpus tools with expert validation enhances both the reliability and reproducibility of terminological decisions.

The findings highlight the importance of parallel corpora as a methodological foundation for achieving terminological alignment in multilingual governance contexts. The proposed framework contributes to improving the quality, consistency, and interoperability of Uzbek translations of UN documents and offers scalable solutions for other low-resource languages in international institutional settings.

Corpus Tools for Developing Intercultural Communication Skills in Future Translators

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ABSTRACT

The increasing globalization of professional communication places translators at the intersection of languages and cultures, requiring them to navigate not only linguistic structures but also intercultural nuances. This paper examines the role of corpus technology in translator education, focusing on its potential to enhance intercultural communication competence. Corpora provide access to authentic, large-scale language data, enabling learners to observe recurrent discourse patterns, pragmatic conventions, and culturally embedded communicative strategies. By engaging with corpus-driven tasks, students are encouraged to move beyond surface-level translation and develop sensitivity to cultural variation in meaning, register, and rhetorical organization.

The study outlines pedagogical approaches that integrate corpus tools into classroom practice, including comparative analysis of parallel corpora, exploration of collocational norms, and investigation of genre-specific discourse. These activities allow future translators to identify divergences between source and target language conventions, fostering awareness of how cultural values and communicative traditions shape textual production. The paper also highlights the transformative potential of error analysis when mediated through corpora: rather than being viewed as isolated mistakes, errors become gateways to deeper insights into intercultural differences.

Practical examples illustrate how corpus-based exercises can be embedded into translator training modules, equipping students with analytical strategies that strengthen both linguistic precision and intercultural adaptability. The findings suggest that corpus technology serves as a bridge between theoretical knowledge and professional practice, cultivating translators who are not only accurate but also culturally responsive. Ultimately, the integration of corpora into translator education contributes to the development of professionals capable of mediating across cultures with clarity, sensitivity, and confidence.

KEYWORDS *Corpus Technology, Translator Education, Intercultural Communication, Translation Pedagogy, Error Analysis, Parallel Corpora, Corpora and Translation Studies.*

The Role of Ad Hoc Corpora in Translation Studies: An Empirical Study on Corpus-Assisted Specialized Text Translation

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ABSTRACT

Corpus-based approaches are increasingly important in translation education while also contributing to the development of machine translation. This study aims to examine the effects of monolingual ad hoc corpora on the translation competence of undergraduate students when translating specialized texts into a second language. In this context, it investigates how corpus use enhances students' translation skills and how potential challenges encountered during the process affect their competency gains.

The study adopts mixed-methods design. An ad hoc corpus of 20 English texts from the Journal of Holistic Healthcare was compiled and converted from PDF to TXT for analysis in Ant Conc. The study plans to include 20 undergraduate students from Sakarya University's English Translation and Interpreting Department with intermediate-advanced English and no corpus experience. Students will complete a pre-test translation using dictionaries, attend a four-hour Ant Conc training, and perform a second translation using ad hoc corpora. The translations will be analyzed for lexical variety, terminological consistency, collocation patterns, and translation decisions, while students' perceptions and self-assessments will be collected via survey. Data will be presented using quantitative and qualitative methods.

Findings are expected to show that corpus use increases translation awareness, but tool difficulties and extra resource needs may affect learning. In conclusion, ad hoc corpora are considered effective pedagogical tools that complement existing practices in translation education. This study aims to fill the gap in the literature regarding the pedagogical potential of ad hoc corpus use by providing empirical data on the implementation of corpus-assisted translation teaching at the undergraduate level.

KEYWORDS *Corpus-Based Translation, Ad Hoc Corpora, Translation Education, Ant Conc.*

A Gender-Oriented Approach to Developing Sociolinguistic Competence in Translator Training through COCA Comparative Tasks

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ABSTRACT

In contemporary translation studies, sociolinguistic competence is considered a crucial component of professional translator training, as translators must understand not only linguistic structures but also sociocultural patterns of language use. This study explores the development of sociolinguistic competence among future translators through a gender-oriented pedagogical approach supported by corpus linguistics. In particular, the research utilizes the Corpus of Contemporary American English (COCA) as a corpus-based resource for analyzing gender-related language patterns and discourse practices.

The study aims to design and evaluate a corpus-informed instructional model that integrates gender-sensitive analysis into translator education. The research methodology combines theoretical analysis, corpus-based linguistic investigation, curriculum analysis, classroom observation, surveys, and pedagogical experimentation. Using the COCA corpus, students were engaged in data-driven learning activities that involved identifying gender-marked lexical choices, discourse strategies, and pragmatic features in authentic texts across different registers.

The results of the pedagogical experiment demonstrate that corpus-assisted instruction significantly improves students' ability to recognize gendered language patterns, interpret sociolinguistic variation, and produce culturally appropriate translations. The findings suggest that integrating corpus linguistics with gender-oriented pedagogy enhances critical linguistic awareness and strengthens sociolinguistic competence in translator training.

The study concludes that corpus-based approaches, particularly those utilizing large authentic corpora such as COCA, provide effective methodological tools for developing sociolinguistic and intercultural competence in future translators.

KEYWORDS *sociolinguistic competence, corpus linguistics, gender approach, translator training, data-driven learning, gendered language, translation pedagogy.*

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TRACK 05

Interdisciplinary Approaches

Selected abstracts and emerging research

Emergency Language Proficiency: Building a Corpus of Emergency English

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ABSTRACT

Building communication during an emergency has become an increasingly important and global concern in today's rapidly changing world. To ensure public and environmental safety in an emergency, clear, understandable, and effective communication should be established between rescue teams and individuals. As a fundamental requirement for such communications, people should be equipped with essential, relevant, and situation-specific vocabulary. Lexical knowledge of emergency-related vocabulary can be enhanced through using corpus-based data. However, the literature notes the scarcity of studies on emergency-specific vocabulary.

To address this issue, this study offers a sample corpus for emergency English, developed within a TÜBİTAK 1001 project (No. 123K768) aiming to develop and implement an Emergency English language teaching program for 4th-grade primary school students. The proposed corpus includes English words, phrases, and fixed utterances, categorized by emergency contexts and themes. This evidence-based, data-driven "Emergency English" vocabulary contributes to the development of instructional materials to improve emergency-related language proficiency. In addition, this corpus can be adaptable to learners' ages, proficiency levels, and teaching content.

KEYWORDS *emergency language proficiency, corpus building, Emergency English vocabulary.*

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TRACK 06

NLP and SentimentAnalysis

Selected abstracts and emerging research

Sentiment Analysis in Natural Language Processing

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ABSTRACT

Natural Language Processing (NLP) is an important field that develops computers' ability to understand, interpret, and process human language. One of its key directions, sentiment analysis, focuses on identifying the emotional tone expressed in texts. Through sentiment analysis, texts are classified into positive, negative, or neutral categories. The main objective of sentiment analysis is to automatically interpret human opinions. The growing volume of textual data such as social media posts, reviews, discussions, and news has significantly increased the importance of this field. In modern times, companies widely use sentiment analysis to measure customer satisfaction, analyze user behavior, and identify market trends.

The approaches used in this field are generally divided into two main groups: lexicon-based and machine learning-based methods. In the lexicon-based approach, predefined emotional word dictionaries are utilized. Each word is assigned a specific emotional value, and the overall tone of the text is determined based on the sum of these values. On the other hand, machine learning approaches rely on models trained on large volumes of labeled data. These models detect hidden patterns in texts and enable more accurate results. In recent years, the development of deep learning methods has significantly improved the quality of sentiment analysis. Neural networks, particularly recurrent neural networks (RNNs), long short-term memory (LSTM) models, and transformers, help better understand the context of text. These technologies allow for more precise analysis not only at the word level but also at the sentence and discourse levels.

However, sentiment analysis still faces certain challenges. The complexity of language, ambiguity, sarcasm, and irony make the analysis process difficult. For instance, the same word may express different emotional meanings depending on the context. Additionally, differences between languages and cultures affect the generalization capability of models. In conclusion, sentiment analysis is a crucial branch of NLP with wide applications in both theoretical and practical domains. With further advancements in this field, more accurate and context-aware analyses will become possible, contributing to more effective human-computer interaction.

KEYWORDS *sentiment analysis, natural language processing, machine learning, deep learning, neural networks, text analysis, computational linguistics.*

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TRACK 07

Opinion Mining in Social, Political, and Cultural Discourse

Selected abstracts and emerging research

Digital Resistance and Narrative Construction: A Critical Discourse Analysis of Imran Khan Hashtag Campaigns in Pakistan

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ABSTRACT

This research explores how the hashtag practice among the followers of Imran Khan on X (previously known as Twitter) is used to produce the narrative of resistance in Pakistan. Using the Fairclough's three-dimensional framework, the research focuses on the analysis of 30 hashtags where one publicly posted message for each hashtag is analyzed inductively for the narrative content and leads to the formation of 48 codes in seven categories. On the textual level, the hashtags mention Imran Khan in such a way that presupposes the common knowledge, provide the directives to an unidentifiable power, and make the collective declarations about being the voice of the nation. In terms of discourse level, production is no longer done on the level of official party narratives but instead moves to the user-level narrative, where slogans are transformed to present different arguments. On the social practice level, there is an increase in hashtag usage in November 2025 with the 27th Constitutional Amendment, with the introduction of more obvious state narratives. The nationalist discourse ties these narratives together, viewing the leader's liberation as a savior for the country.

KEYWORDS *Critical Discourse Analysis, hashtag activism, Fairclough, Imran Khan, Pakistan, X.*

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